



Official Rules (Short Version): 07.10.2025 FCFS - Gi / FCFS - No Gi

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1. Permitted Actions in FCFS-PRO Division.

In FCFS-PRO Division matches, the following technical actions are permitted: Throws, holds, chokes and joint locks, defense and counterattacks, strikes with legs, hands, and knees. - No Gi division: Chokeholds with hands directly on the opponent's neck are allowed. - Gi division: Chokes with hands only on the neck are prohibited; chokes through the neck and arm of the opponent, as well as chokes using the jacket (including variants with direct pressure on the neck), are allowed.

In all other aspects, the rules in the Gi and No Gi divisions are identical; differences relate only to attire and the specified restrictions on chokeholds.

2. Athlete Uniform

2.1 Jacket (Gi Division)

- Standard sambo jacket with belt.
- The athlete called first must wear a red or black jacket. The athlete called second must wear a blue or white jacket.

2.2 Belt (Gi Division)

- The athlete may wear a belt matching the color of the jacket or a belt indicating their level of training in FCFS or another martial art.

2.3 Footwear

- Athletes compete barefoot. In the Gi division, soft leather or similar material footwear covering the foot and ankle is allowed, without hard soles and metal elements.

2.4 Shorts

- Loose-fitting fighting or wrestling shorts that do not restrict movement. Without pockets, without metal elements, without hard fasteners or Velcro.
- Length – no higher than mid-thigh and no lower than the knee. Shorts color according to tournament regulations.

2.5 Rash Guard

- Tight-fitting elastic shirt with long or short sleeves. Without pockets, zippers, or protruding elements. In the Gi division, competing without a rash guard under the jacket is allowed.

2.6 Leggings

- Tight-fitting compression pants.
- Must be without pockets, zippers, or additional elements that could lead to gripping.

- Competing without leggings is allowed.

2.7 Gloves

- MMA (Mixed Martial Arts) type gloves are used in the combat division.
- Glove weight: 4–6 oz for adult categories; 6–8 oz — for juniors and beginner athletes.
- Gloves must provide protection for hands and joints while maintaining the ability to perform grips and holds.
- Soft striking surface and secure wrist fixation (Velcro or strap) are mandatory.
- Any metal, plastic, or other hard inserts are prohibited, as well as damaged or excessively worn gloves.
- Gloves must be clean, dry, and approved by the referee or official representative before the match begins.

2.8 Shin Guards

- Protective shin and instep guards (shin guards) are used in the combat division, similar to those used in amateur MMA.
- Guards must be made of soft synthetic or leather materials with dense cushioning, providing protection for the shin and foot.
- The design must be securely fastened with Velcro or elastic straps and not shift during the match.
- Guards with hard inserts, metal elements, or rigid frames are prohibited.
- Guards must be clean, dry, and free of damage that could cause injury to the opponent.
- Inspection and approval of guards is carried out by the referee or official representative before the match begins.

2.9 Headgear

- In the combat division, athletes must use protective headgear (head guard) designed for MMA or combat sambo type matches.
- Headgear must provide protection for the forehead, cheeks, chin, and back of the head, while not restricting the athlete's vision and breathing.
- Models with open face or with soft cheek protection are allowed. In amateur bouts, using headgear with chin protection is preferable.
- Headgear material — synthetic or natural leather with internal soft cushioning layer.
- Headgear with hard elements, metal fasteners, or damaged sections is prohibited.
- Headgear must be clean, dry, and match the athlete's head size.
- Inspection and approval of headgear is conducted by the referee or official representative before the match begins.

3.0 Additional Requirements

- Any elements that may injure the opponent (zippers, hard pads, etc.) are prohibited.

3. Referee Panel

In FCFS matches, the mat is supervised by three referees, while the chief referee is responsible for the overall competition.

4. Match Procedure and Main Time

1. Athletes are called to the mat: red/black — to the red corner, blue/white — to the blue.
2. Before the start — enter the center, handshake, step back. At the referee's command "Fight," the match begins.
3. The command "Stop" stops the fight. After it, resumption is always from standing position at the command "Fight."
4. The command "Time" - end of main match time.
5. Actions and violations performed before time expires on the scoreboard (or manual timer) are counted. After "Stop" or "Time," actions are not evaluated.
6. Result: the referee in the center raises the winner's hand, athletes shake hands and leave the mat.
7. The match is conducted in clean time: the countdown begins at the command "Fight," pauses are not counted.

5. Standing Actions (Throws and Strikes)

1. No points are awarded for an unsuccessful throw with the attacker's fall if there was no counterattack.
2. Counter-throw — active interception of an attack with change of its direction or stoppage.
3. If the defender does not change the fall and falls together with the attacker, the throw is counted for the attacker.
4. Only throws initiated by the attacker from standing position are counted. If the attacker is in ground position, the throw is not counted.
5. Throw without fall — attacker remains standing at all times. Such throws are rated higher.
6. Throw with fall — attacker goes to ground or leans on the opponent.
7. Lifting the opponent from ground with complete separation and rotation is considered a throw from standing.
8. If the attacker in standing position throws the opponent from ground position, the throw is evaluated at half value.
9. Transitioning to a joint lock with the opponent's fall is counted as a throw with pronounced fall.
10. Permitted strikes in standing: strikes with hands (fist or palm), legs (foot or shin). Knee strikes are allowed only to the body.
11. Prohibited strikes in standing: strikes with head, elbows, knees to the head, as well as strikes to the back of the head, spine, neck, throat, trachea, groin, and joints. Striking an opponent in ground position (three or more points of contact) is prohibited. Intentional strikes on an opponent who has stopped actively defending or is under referee control are not allowed. For violation of these rules, the referee immediately stops the

match and applies a warning, point deduction, or disqualification — depending on the severity of the violation.

12. Opponent's fall caused by a permitted strike with hand, leg, or knee, where the opponent loses balance and touches the mat with any body part, is equivalent to a throw.
13. Fall not caused by opponent's action (e.g., loss of balance without contact) is not counted as a throw.

6. Ground Actions (Grappling and Strikes)

1. Ground fighting begins when both opponents are in "lying" position. After each transition to ground, 1 minute is allotted for grappling (30 seconds for amateurs and children under 12).
2. If at the moment the allotted time for ground fighting expires, there is a countdown for executing a hold, joint lock, or choke, it continues until completion of the 10-second countdown. If submission occurs during this period, it is recorded according to the rules. After the countdown completion, the match is stopped and opponents are raised to standing.
3. If a joint lock or choke was secured before the end of match signal (gong or "Time" command), the countdown for its execution continues according to established rules – 10 seconds, despite the end of main match time. If during these 10 seconds the opponent submits, the submission is recorded according to the rules.
4. Ground fighting continues as long as one or both athletes are taking active actions: attacking, defending, transitioning from technique to technique, or dynamically attempting to change position.
5. Ground fighting stops if:
 - One of the athletes signals submission.
 - One of the athletes stands up.
 - Both athletes exit the mat's working area.
 - Both athletes are fixed in a static position without attempts to attack or defend. In this case, the referee raises them to standing.
 - If the opponent stops actively defending and the opponent continues delivering permitted hand strikes, the referee immediately stops the fight and records early victory (technical knockout).
 - If strikes become excessively hard and create real threat of injury, the referee stops the fight, issues a warning to the attacker, or announces technical knockout — depending on the situation.
6. Joint locks and chokes may only be initiated when the defender is in "lying" position, while the attacker may be in "standing" position.
7. The beginning of a joint lock is the moment in the match when the attacker secures the opponent's limb with intent to cause pain and creates a threat of finishing the technique. The chief referee on the mat signals the start with the command "Submission" and begins counting.
8. The beginning of a choke is the moment in the match when the attacker secures the opponent's neck and creates a visible threat to the referee of restricting or completely stopping blood flow to the brain or air to the lungs with intent to achieve submission or loss of consciousness. Simulation of a choke is not grounds for its recognition.
9. Executing such fixation of a joint lock or choke is scored at 1 point if it was continu-

ously applied and created a threat of completion for 10 seconds, regardless of whether the technique is held longer.

10. If a joint lock or choke does not present a threat of completion, the referee does not start the time countdown for its execution.
11. After completing the 10-second countdown for one such technique, the referee gives the command “One Point,” records the awarding of 1 point and stops the countdown, but continues to keep the fist clenched if a dangerous position and threat of completion persists.
12. Holding the same technique does not award additional points, regardless of how long it is held. To earn subsequent points, the athlete must transition to another joint lock or choke and secure it, after which the referee begins a new time countdown. Or finish this joint lock with the opponent’s submission.
13. If the threat of completing the technique disappears, the referee opens the fist and stops the countdown. If the threat resumes, the referee clenches the fist again and continues the countdown from the beginning: “One, Two, Three.”
14. The number of joint locks and chokes for which points can be earned during 1 minute of ground fighting is unlimited.
15. If after fixation begins, but not less than 3 seconds into the countdown, the opponent escaping the joint lock or choke stands up, while the referee continued counting and kept the hand in a fist showing dangerous position and threat of completion, the athlete executing the technique is awarded 1 point.
16. If this occurred after 10 seconds of counting, and the referee continued to fix the dangerous position with a clenched fist, the athlete executing the technique receives 1 point for 10 seconds of execution and an additional 1 point for the opponent’s escape to standing from a dangerous position.
17. If the opponent managed to stand up before 3 seconds of counting elapsed after fixation, no points are awarded to anyone.
18. Execution of a leg lock must be stopped as soon as the defender transitions to “standing” position and secures a stable position.
19. Execution of an arm lock must be stopped as soon as both athletes are in standing position (complete separation of the opponent from the mat).
20. Execution of a choke must be stopped as soon as the defender transitions to “standing” position.
21. A joint lock is counted as completed if during its execution the defender signals submission. A submission signal is given by a loud cry and/or repeated tapping with hand or foot on the mat, on one’s own body, or on the opponent’s body. Any cry from a participant caught in a joint lock is considered a submission signal.
22. A submission signal from a choke is given by any distinct cry, gasp, and/or repeated tapping with hand or foot on the mat, on one’s own body, or on the opponent’s body.
23. Stopping the match at the request of the defender under a joint lock or choke, if not caused by a rules violation by the attacker, is treated as a submission signal.
24. Submission from a joint lock or choke is recorded by the referee with the command “Stop, Submission Done” and scored at 6 points. After confirmed submission, the referee awards points and raises athletes to standing.
25. In case of submission from a technique after full 10-second fixation (i.e., after completion of the time countdown), this joint lock or choke is awarded the maximum score of 6 points, analogous to submission that occurred during the first 10 seconds.
26. If one of the athletes, escaping a joint lock or choke, clearly crawled out together with

the opponent beyond the mat's working area boundary, while the referee continued counting or fixed the dangerous position with a clenched fist, their opponent receives 1 point.

27. If both athletes exited the working area boundaries during active mutual ground fighting, no points are awarded to anyone. In both cases (6.25/6.26) the match is stopped and opponents are raised to standing.
28. On the ground, only hand strikes (fist or palm) are permitted. Ground position is when an athlete has three or more points of contact on the mat. Striking from standing position on an opponent in ground position is prohibited.
29. Strikes to the back of the head, spine, neck, joints, and groin are prohibited, as well as strikes with elbows, legs, and knees in any position. The referee immediately stops the match when these rules are violated and issues a warning, penalty, or disqualification depending on the degree of violation.

7. Chokes and Joint Locks

7.1 Permitted Categories of Chokes

All types of chokes are permitted (with and without clothing, with hands and legs); a complete list of permitted actions is provided in the official FCFS rules.

7.2 Prohibited Chokes

- Gi division only: Chokes with hands directly on the neck without using the jacket or opponent's arm.
- Chokes with pressure on the chin. Techniques where the main impact is on the lower jaw and larynx, rather than the neck.
- Chokes affecting the spine or twisting the neck. Any techniques creating excessive load on the cervical spine.
- Belt chokes.
- Leg chokes applied only to the neck without securing the opponent's arm.
- Straightening crossed legs creating pressure on the neck.
- Jerking and excessively aggressive chokes performed with sharp movements creating risk of serious injury to the neck or spine.

7.3 Prohibited Joint Locks

- Joint locks on fingers and toes, as well as wrists.
- Foot knots and locks (Knot Foot Lock, Foot Lock, Toe Hold, Straight Ankle Lock, Heel Hook, Twisting Foot Lock).
- Knee bar with hyperextension outside the natural bending plane.
- Hard and sharp bending of the arm behind the back ("Police Lock").
- Joint pressure on the spine, including special techniques (neck crank, twister and similar), straightening crossed legs creating pressure on the spine.

8. Holds

1. The hold countdown begins at the referee's command "Hold" from the moment the attacker presses their torso to the opponent's torso (or to the opponent's arms pressed to the torso) and secures them in the "on shoulder blades" position. Extends arm palm down and counts seconds with arm movement: "One... Nine." At "Ten – One point" the holder is awarded 1 point. If the hold is broken earlier — the count stops and the hold is not scored.
2. Holds are scored at 1 point for 10 seconds of execution. The number of holds during a match is unlimited. But one hold is scored only once for each transition to ground.
3. A hold ends if:
 - the athlete being held transitions to "on chest," "on stomach," or "on buttocks" (but not "on lower back") position, where the angle between their back at shoulder blade level and the mat plane exceeds 90 degrees;
 - the tightness of the hold is lost and becomes insufficient for effective control of the held athlete's torso and restriction of their movement;
 - the attacker or defender transitions to applying a joint lock;
 - during the hold both athletes end up in the "off the mat" position;
 - the held athlete hooks the holding athlete's leg or torso with both legs simultaneously (hooking / leg entanglement with both legs), or crosses legs around the holding athlete's leg or torso;
 - the held athlete is in guard or half-guard position, i.e., has the holding athlete's leg under control, regardless of grip depth or strength.
4. A hold is counted as a submission if during its execution the held athlete signals surrender.
5. Stopping the match at the request of the defender being held, if not caused by a rules violation by the attacker, is treated as a submission signal.
6. If a hold was secured before the end of match signal (gong or "Time" command), or before the end of allotted time for ground fighting, the countdown for its execution continues according to established rules – 10 seconds, despite the end of main or allotted match time. If during these 10 seconds the opponent submits, the submission is recorded according to the rules.

9. Actions Near the Mat Boundary

1. During the match, athletes do not have the right to exit the mat without the referee's permission.
2. At the referee's decision, an athlete may leave the mat to replace athletic uniform (side referee must accompany the athlete).
3. "Out of bounds" position is considered if:
 - in standing position, both athletes stepped with both feet beyond the mat's working area boundary;
 - in "lying" position, both athletes ended up beyond the mat's working area boundary;
 - in "lying" position, one of the athletes has contact with the area beyond the mat's safety zone.
4. During the match, "out of bounds" position is determined by one of the referees, and

when discussing disputed moments, by majority of the referee trio.

5. Upon finding themselves in “out of bounds” position, athletes at the referee’s “Stop” command return to the mat center and resume the match in “standing” position.
6. A throw (counter-throw) started within the mat’s working area and finished beyond it, but within the mat’s safety zone, is scored, provided that after the fall, the defender’s torso remains entirely within the mat’s safety zone.
7. A throw (counter-throw) started within the mat’s working area and finished beyond the mat’s safety zone is not scored (if any part of the defender’s torso is beyond the mat’s safety zone).
8. A throw started in “out of bounds” position is not scored.
9. A hold and joint lock may be initiated, executed, and scored while one of the athletes has contact with the mat’s working area, and the second athlete must be within the mat’s safety zone.

10. Scoring for Techniques and Throws

The scoring of a throw depends on: - whether the attacker executed the throw without fall or with fall; - what position the defender was in; - what body part the defender fell on as a result of the throw.

During the match, scoring of athletes’ technical actions is determined by majority vote of the referee trio.

Six points (6 Points) - referee shows straight arm up, palm open: - For a throw without the attacker’s fall, in which the opponent fell on the back or into “bridge” position - For opponent’s submission under the impact of a joint lock or choke, as well as during a hold - During knockdown, when the referee begins counting.

Four points (4 Points) - bent arm up, showing 4 fingers: - For a throw without the attacker’s fall, in which the opponent fell on the side or into “half-bridge” position; - For a throw with the attacker’s fall, in which the opponent fell on the back or into “bridge” position; - For a throw without the attacker’s fall, in which the opponent in lying position fell on the back or into “bridge” position;

Two points (2 Points) - bent arm up, showing 2 fingers: - For a throw without the attacker’s fall, in which the opponent fell on the chest, stomach, buttocks, lower back, or shoulder. - For a throw with the attacker’s fall, in which the opponent fell on the side or into “half-bridge” position. - For a throw in which the opponent in lying position fell on the back or into “bridge” position.

One point (1 Point) - bent arm up, showing thumb: - For a throw with the attacker’s fall, in which the opponent fell on the chest, stomach, buttock(s), lower back, or shoulder. - For a throw in which the opponent in lying position fell on the side or into “half-bridge” position. - For the first penalty announced to the opponent. - For fixation of a hold for 10 seconds. - For holding and executing a joint lock or choke for 10 seconds. - For escaping to standing from a joint lock or choke during its fixation by the referee, if fixation lasted 3 seconds or more. - For crawling out beyond the mat’s working area boundary with the opponent in an attempt to avoid a joint lock or choke.

11. Match to Golden Score

If the main match time ends without a winner with a tie result, an additional minute of fighting to “Golden Score” is given. During this period, fighting continues until the first scoring action (1 point or more) or penalty. After the additional minute expires, the winner is determined by the referee trio’s decision.

12. Early Victory is Awarded

1. When one of the athletes is first to score 12 points, regardless of the score difference.
2. Knockout — if the opponent is not ready to continue the fight before the end of the 10-second countdown or shows no signs of movement after a strike, the referee immediately stops the match and records a knockout.
3. Upon removal of the opponent from the match or their disqualification.

13. Warnings and Penalties

13.1 Warning

1. The mat referee first issues a warning if an athlete commits a minor violation, exits the mat, evades fighting, delays time, etc.
2. A warning does not affect the match result and is not recorded in the referee protocol.
3. If the athlete continues to violate rules or avoids fighting after a warning, they receive a penalty.

13.2 Penalties and Their Consequences

1. First penalty — 1 point to opponent
2. Second penalty — 2 points to opponent
3. Third penalty — outright defeat (disqualification for penalties)

13.3 Additional Provisions

1. For gross violations or unsportsmanlike behavior, the referee may immediately assign outright defeat without prior penalties.
2. All penalties are recorded in the referee protocol.
3. During the match, warnings and penalties are announced by majority vote of the referee trio.

13.4 Actions Leading to Warnings and Penalties

1. Intentional time stalling.
2. Dangerous or prohibited actions (prohibited strikes, rough fighting, equipment violations).
3. Arguing with referees, unsportsmanlike behavior.

4. Frequent and obvious voluntary or intentional exit beyond the working area boundary in standing or lying position.
5. Passivity (evading grip in standing position, refusing attacking actions, stalling match time).
6. False attack (transition to lying position without real attack, defender does not lose balance).
7. Frequent pushing out (moving opponent beyond the working area boundary using blocking grip, without intent to execute a throw).
8. Intentional violation of uniform (rolling up jacket sleeves, untying belt and laces, removing wrestling shoes, etc.).
9. Simulating fighting.
10. Prohibited grips:
 - Intentional grip on shorts, on laces and wrestling shoes from inside
 - Intentional grip on fingers on opponent's hands and feet
11. For late arrival to mat:
 - 30 sec – 1 penalty.
 - 90 sec – 2 penalties.
 - 120 sec – 3 penalties and removal from match.

13.5 Prohibited Techniques That Immediately Result in a Penalty

For executing a prohibited technique, the athlete is immediately given a penalty with scoring, and upon repeated attempt to execute a prohibited technique, the athlete is removed from the match. 1. Rough execution of prohibited technique. 2. Intentional throw of opponent on the head. 3. Intentional execution of joint lock after “Stop” command. 4. Execution of joint lock while opponent is in standing position. 5. Execution of “Scissors” technical action. 6. Direct painful impact on spine and neck. 7. Joint locks on fingers, toes, and wrists. 8. Foot knots and locks (Knot Foot Lock, Foot Lock, Toe Hold, Straight Ankle Lock, Heel Hook, Twisting Foot Lock). 9. Knee bar hyperextending it outside the natural bending plane. 10. Hard and sharp bending of arm behind the back “Police Lock.” 11. Direct impact with elbow or knee on any part of opponent's body. 12. Prohibited strikes. 13. Lifting opponent followed by slamming onto mat (slamming) to exit guard, as well as to escape from joint lock or choke (e.g., armbar, triangle choke). 14. Pressure on eyes, plugging ears, open grips on face. 15. Grips on throat with direct compression of trachea or larynx. 16. Special impacts on spine, including straightening crossed legs creating pressure on neck or opponent's spine, as well as techniques like (neck crank / twister); 17. Inserting fingers into mouth or nostrils (fish hooking). 18. Pressure or strikes to groin. 19. Obscene, offensive, or provocative actions toward opponent, referees, and spectators.

14. Athlete Removal from Match

Removal of an athlete from a match is carried out by the chief referee's decision if the referee trio made a unanimous decision or if the majority of referees supports this decision. In this case, the match is immediately stopped and their opponent is awarded early victory. Removal of an athlete from a match occurs in case of: 1. Repeated execution of prohibited technique. 2. Doctor's decision (if athlete cannot continue competition participation (illness, injury, vomiting). 3. As a result of exceeding time and penalty limits: - if athlete

could not fit within the allotted 2 minutes for medical assistance - late arrival to mat after 2 minutes from first call - after three warnings when it becomes necessary to announce a fourth warning to athlete

15. Disqualification

Disqualification occurs in case of: 1. Unethical behavior. 2. Intentional rough strike, scratches, bites. 3. Inflicting injury on opponent as a result of executing prohibited technique, when the latter is unable to continue competition. 4. Offensive swearing and gestures toward opponent, referees, participants, spectators.

16. Submission Fixation and Match Stoppage (Children Under 12, White and Yellow Belts)

1. Submission is fixed upon obvious signal (clapping, voice, other signs).
2. The referee immediately stops the fight and counts the submission:
 - upon complete straightening of arm in joint lock;
 - upon complete straightening of knee in “knee bar” with leg fixation;
 - during choke — upon loss of active defense or signs of loss of consciousness.
3. If technique is executed dangerously (against natural joint bending, etc.), the referee gives “Stop” and transitions the fight to standing without penalty.
4. During rough or intentionally dangerous action (excessive force, prohibited technique) — the referee gives “Stop” and issues a penalty to the attacker.

17. Strike Specifics in Matches (Children Under 14, White and Yellow Belts)

- Only strikes to the body are permitted — with hands (fist or palm) and legs (foot or shin).
- Any strikes to the head and any strikes with knees, elbows, and head are prohibited.
- In ground position, delivering any strikes is prohibited.
- Matches are conducted with emphasis on technique, control, and safety, not on strike power.
- The referee must immediately stop the fight if excessive harshness or loss of self-control by one of the participants occurs.

18. Referee Gestures

All referee gestures are described in detail in the full version of the official FCFS rules.